

DOUGLAS DE CASTRO DAMASIO

Senior Software Engineer — Backend & Distributed Systems

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SUMMARY

Senior backend engineer with 10+ years of experience — including 6+ years in distributed systems and 4 years at Nubank — designing and operating large-scale systems serving 100M+ customers across 5 countries with millions of transactions processed daily. Led Authorization's side of a 4-team debit launch that shipped 50% faster than the prior comparable effort, built a real-time observability platform that cut incident investigation time from next-day to immediate, and was an early, heavy user of an AI-assisted framework that grew engineering throughput 5x. Comfortable across the stack — Clojure, Python, JavaScript/TypeScript — with hands-on experience in Kafka, DynamoDB, Kubernetes, and Terraform. Mentors engineers and works cross-functionally with product and design.

SKILLS

Languages: Clojure, Python, Scala, JavaScript, TypeScript

Architecture: Distributed systems, microservices, event-driven architecture, high availability, system design

Backend & Data: DynamoDB, Datomic, SQL/NoSQL, FastAPI, Flask, REST APIs

Message Queues: Apache Kafka

Platform & Infra: AWS, Kubernetes, Terraform, CI/CD, Infrastructure as Code

Leadership: Cross-team technical coordination, mentorship, code review, technical design

AI-assisted engineering: Claude Code, Cursor, GitHub Copilot, NotebookLM — daily use for development, debugging, code review, documentation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer — Nubank (Brazil's largest fintech)

Dec 2021 – Present · Hybrid

- Led Authorization's engineering execution for the Colombia debit launch, interfacing with the Fraud, Cards, and Debit teams — shipped **50% faster** than the previous comparable market launch (details below).
- Owned backend services processing **~1,700 transactions/second** across debit and credit products in all markets, maintaining **99.97% uptime** and **sub-1-second authorization latency**.
- Promoted to Senior Software Engineer following the Colombia launch; has remained an individual contributor since.
- Designed and built a real-time observability service for the authorization pipeline: captured raw Mastercard messages via Kafka before parsing, stored in DynamoDB, exposed via REST API — cut incident investigation time from **next-day to immediate**. Mentored a mid-level engineer through design and rollout.
- Early adopter and top user of an AI-assisted migration framework that converted legacy business rules into a new layered authorization architecture — the framework grew migration throughput from **<20 rules/year to 33 rules in 6 months**, with 10 more in progress (details below).
- Built and operated backend microservices in Clojure for Nubank's payment authorization platform, processing transactions across Brazil, Mexico, Colombia, USA, and Switzerland for 100M+ customers.
- Cut infrastructure provisioning time from **21 days to 1 day** by designing Infrastructure as Code with Terraform.
- Coordinated the gateway/boards team through PCI-DSS certification — delivered with **zero pending items in 3 months**.

Stack: Clojure, Kafka, DynamoDB, AWS, Kubernetes, Terraform

Software Engineer — Telavita (Brazilian digital healthcare platform)

Aug 2020 – Dec 2021 · Remote

- Built and maintained backend services and REST APIs in Python (FastAPI/Flask) for a digital healthcare platform.

- Built a command to onboard new partner healthcare providers (convênios) after refactoring **~40% of the backend codebase** — cut onboarding time from **one sprint (2 weeks) to instant**.
- Refactored core business logic out of a legacy monolith into modular backend components as part of a platform modernization effort.
- Delivered customer-facing features end-to-end across backend, frontend, database, and cloud infrastructure, working directly with product managers and designers.

Stack: Python, FastAPI, JavaScript, React, TypeScript, SQL

Freelance Python/Flask Instructor — Independent

Concurrent with Telavita, 2020–2021

- Independently contracted by a company to deliver a multi-week Python/Flask training program for 5-15 of their engineers, upskilling them in backend development.

Systems Analyst — Farmarin (Brazilian pharmaceutical company)

Feb 2012 – Jul 2020

- Progressed from Intern to mid-level Systems Analyst over 8 years, owning internal IT support and network infrastructure for the company.
- In the final year, led development of two internal mobile apps (Python backend, Kivy frontend) that extended the company's Sankhya ERP for field maintenance staff and drivers without regular computer access — replacing a manual, paper-based process for a team of under 20 field workers.
- The initiative opened the door to further internal app development at the company.

Stack: Python, Kivy, Sankhya ERP, network infrastructure

PROJECTS

Colombia Debit Launch

- Owned authorization-side technical planning and delivery for Nubank's entry into the Colombian debit market.
- Interfaced with Fraud, Cards, and Debit teams and delivered the launch **50% faster** than the prior comparable launch, including Mastercard certification.

AI-Assisted Business Rule Migration Framework

- Was an early, heavy user of an AI-assisted framework that analyzed legacy rules and transformed them into implementations aligned with a new layered architecture.
- Grew migration throughput from fewer than **20 rules/year to 33 rules in 6 months** (10 more in progress).

OPEN SOURCE

- Maintainer, **Dracula Theme** — editor/terminal theme used by millions of developers across multiple platforms.
- Contributor/maintainer, **Adminer**.

EDUCATION

- MBA, Big Data Analytics — Universidade Presbiteriana Mackenzie, São Paulo
- B.Sc., Information Systems (Computer Science) — Centro Universitário Eniac, São Paulo

LANGUAGES

Portuguese — Native | English — Professional working proficiency